

Treasure Hunt Group 6

In this treasure hunt a few strategies have been conducted to find a scholarly article discussing “the impact of information overload on decision-making.” Upon scanning the database list, the “ABI/INFORM Collection” got my attention because at first glance I would say this would have something to do with information overload, but when an advanced search was performed by typing key phrases like “the impact of information overload on decision making,” nothing was lining up with instruction 2. The database that was right below “Academic Search Complete (Ebsco)” seemed more promising. Since this is a scholarly article, the academic search was deemed more appropriate and would broaden the search results. Performing the same key phrase in the advanced search bar, a match was found. The article was titled “Impact of Information Overload on Consumer Decision-Making in the Agri-Food Sector: A Stimulus-Organism-Response Theory Perspective.” In the article, it discusses how consumers are overwhelmed by the massive amounts of information about product choices that are available on online stores for agri-food products. Due to the overload of information, it leads to customer confusion and affects the purchasing power of consumers. Agri-food is the process of producing food through farming; the term farm to fork is at play here. To test this, researchers conducted a study of 430 agri-food customers using the stimulus-organism-response theory to test consumer behavior. According to researchleap.com the definition of S-O-R states: “The S-O-R model suggests that an organism’s internal feelings or behavior (person) are caused by the external environment (stimuli)” (ResearchLeap, n.d., para. 1). The results of the experiment showed that consumers often decide to delay orders or even avoid purchases due to the impact of the overload being in their environment. The research results also confirmed that a customer needs a desire to deeply think and use existing product knowledge to reduce the effects of fatigue of information. People with higher cognitive function are less likely to experience overload.

References

Ying, B., Duan, Y., Zheng, S., & Zheng, X. (2025). Impact of information overload on consumer decision-making in the agri-food sector: A stimulus-organism-response theory perspective. *Journal of Consumer Affairs*, 59(4). <https://doi.org/10.1111/joca.70031>

ResearchLeap. (n.d.). *What is the stimulus-organism-response (S-O-R) model?* <https://researchleap.com/>

Shahrzadi, L., Mansouri, A., Alavi, M., & Shabani, A. (2024). Causes, consequences, and strategies to deal with information overload: A scoping review. *International Journal of Information Management Data Insights*, 4(2), 100261. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jjime.2024.100261>

The article I reviewed for this week's treasure hunt is Examining the influence of information overload on consumers' purchases in live streaming: A heuristic-systematic model perspective. This article looks at the increasing trend of people using live streams to make purchases, the methods or theories they use when making purchasing decisions, and how information overload impacts their decision-making ability. The heuristic-systemic model suggests that people "make judgements based on simple cues such as the characteristics of the source of information (i.e. physical attractiveness) or they make systemic judgements based on sufficient motivation, ability, and cognitive resources" (Zhang et al., 2023). In a typical buying scenario, having more information can increase the buyer's knowledge and confidence about their purchasing decisions. However, in a live streaming scenario "the streamers often repeatedly hype the high value of the product in a short period of time, shaping an intimate environment and reminding users of limited time, so that they are unable to think, and rush to purchase. Under the effect of information overload, consumers' ability to perceive product value and fit may be reduced" (Zhang et al., 2023). While this article focuses on live streaming events; I believe the findings could be generalized to many different scenarios where one must make a decision. I can personally say that anytime I walk into an Ulta or Sephora for a simple purchase of something like mascara and the store personnel gives me 25 options of mascara and proceeds add on options for eye liner etcetera, I default to simplest form of decision making. I either go with what they recommended first or the pick the most trustworthy brand. I believe information overload impedes a person's ability to make the best decision in a short period of time.

References

Zhang, G., Cao, J., & Liu, D. (2023). *Examining the influence of information overload on consumers' purchase in live streaming: A heuristic-systematic model perspective*. [abstract] PLoS One, 18(8) doi:<https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0284466>

The article I reviewed was "Causes, consequences, and strategies to deal with information overload: A scoping review". This review looks at information overload, a growing problem in the digital world caused by too much information from many sources. It shows that overload can harm people and organizations by making it harder to think clearly, increasing stress, lowering performance, and leading to bad decisions.

The review finds five main causes: personal factors (like limited ability to process information and motivation), the nature of the information (such as how much and how good it is), task-related factors (like time pressure), organizational issues, and technology use (Eraslan & Tufan, 2022; Ghorbanian Zolbin et al., 2022; Schmitt et al., 2018).

To fix these problems, the article suggests many strategies, such as improving skills in managing information, designing better information systems, using tools like filters and recommendations, setting clear procedures, and using personal mental strategies like filtering and avoiding unnecessary info (Klerings et al., 2015; Klausegger et al., 2007; Mungly & Singh, 2012). The review stresses that solving information overload needs a combined approach involving individuals, organizations, and technology (Eppler & Mengis, 2004; Bhattacharjee & Hikmet, 2007).

It also talks about the strengths of the review covering many fields and its limitations, like missing some studies and only including English articles. Finally, it recommends future research on specific areas, individual traits, and new technology solutions to better manage this widespread issue (Arksey & O'Malley, 2005; Peters et al., 2020).

Eraslan, P., & Tufan, G. (2022). Cancer information overload may be a crucial determinant of adjuvant aromatase inhibitor adherence. *European Review for Medical and Pharmacological Sciences*, 26(19), 7053–7062. https://doi.org/10.26355/eurrev_202210_29889

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